

A Curious Kid Adventure — Book 2

The Curious Kid Meets Aristotle

by Evan Paliotta

IRONWOOD BOOKS

The Curious Kid Meets Aristotle
A Curious Kid Adventure — Book 2

Text © 2026 Evan Paliotta
Illustrations generated with AI assistance
Published by Ironwood Books
A division of MVP Ventures LLC
Jacksonville Beach, FL

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be
reproduced without written permission from the publisher.

Illustrations in this book were created with the assistance
of artificial intelligence.

First edition, 2026

ISBN: 979-8181939677

ironwoodbooks.com

The Curious Kid sat up in his bed,
to find something new sitting just by his head.



A papyrus scroll lay there, right in the light,
ARISTOTLE stamped at its end, shining bright.

He touched it once — the room gave a spin.
He held on tight, and the world pulled him in.



His farm disappeared and the floor fell away —
he spun through the dark toward a glorious day.

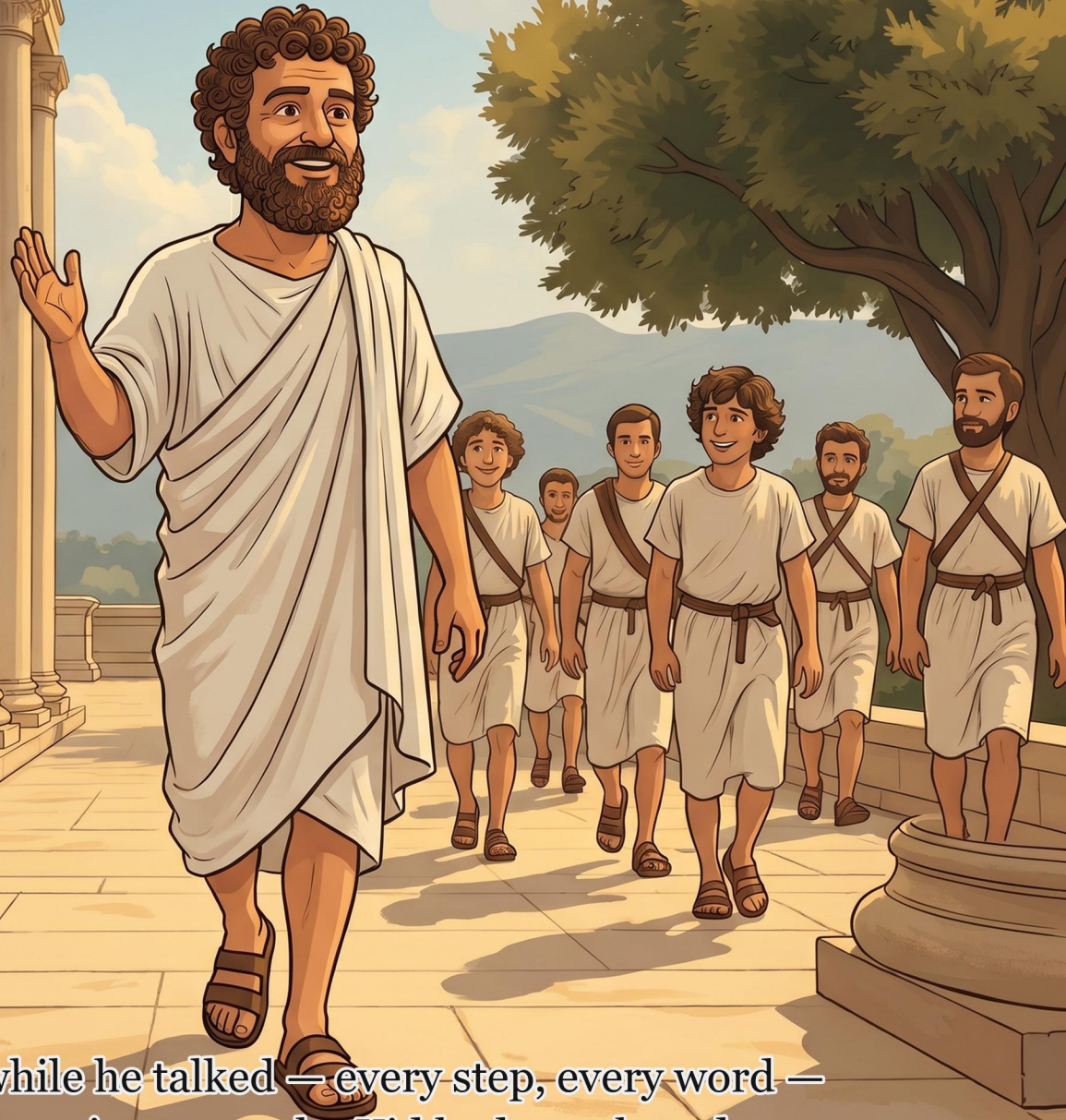
He landed in sunlight and warm golden stone
and looked all around — he wasn't alone.
A city stretched out in the afternoon heat,
with marble and olives and sandals on feet.



He followed the voices — they led him inside
to a courtyard of columns and shade stretching wide.
The students were walking and talking in pairs,
while the breeze moved the olive leaves up through the air.



And there in the middle, with bright, laughing eyes,
stood a man in white robes, warm and wise.

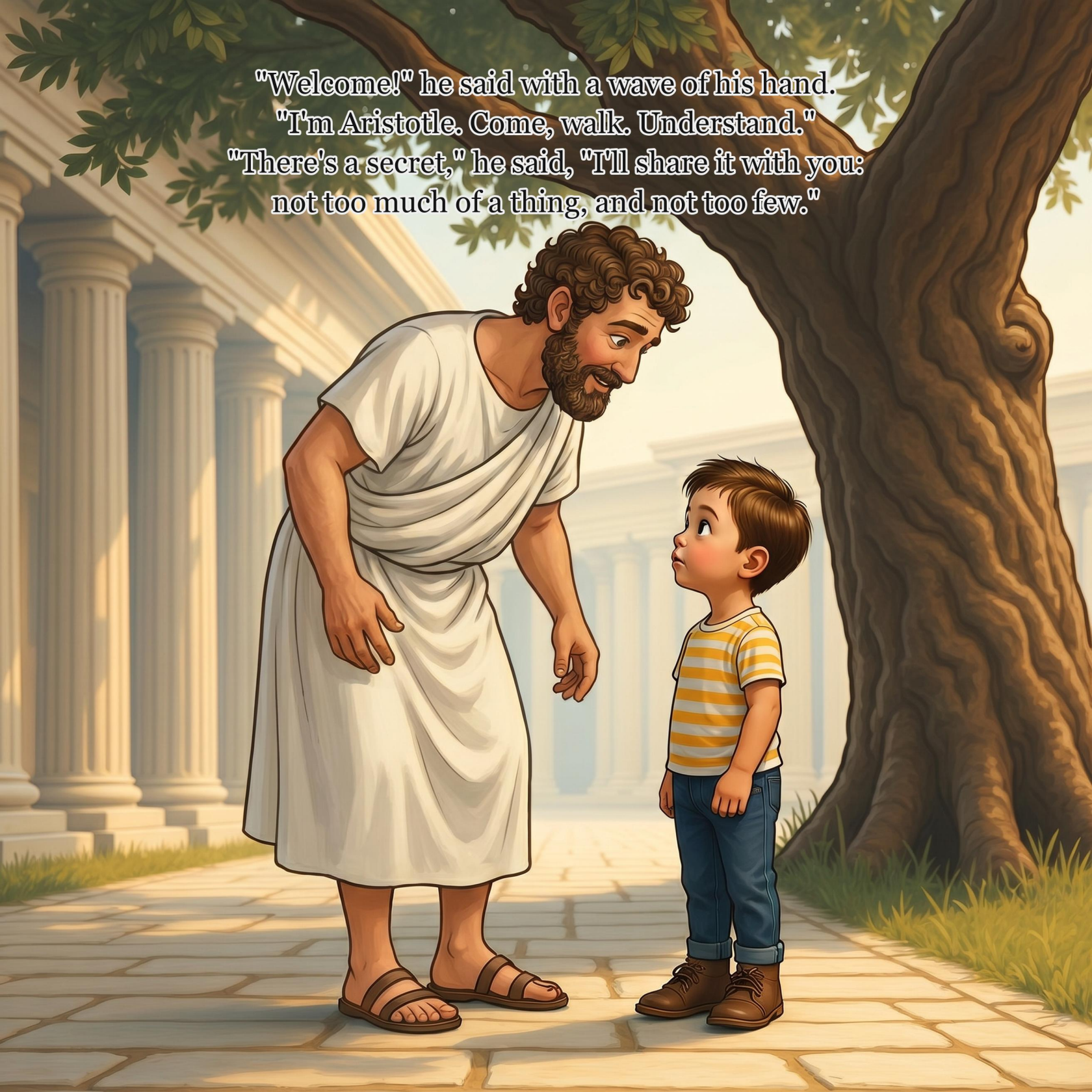


He walked while he talked — every step, every word —
the most curious man the Kid had ever heard.

"Welcome!" he said with a wave of his hand.

"I'm Aristotle. Come, walk. Understand."

"There's a secret," he said, "I'll share it with you:
not too much of a thing, and not too few."



"What do you mean?" asked the Kid with a hop.
"Don't leave anything out — say it all, every drop!"
"Let's start," said the teacher, "with something you know:
think of sleep — how you need it to grow."



Too little sleep makes you grumpy and slow.
Too much, and you're sluggish with nowhere to go.



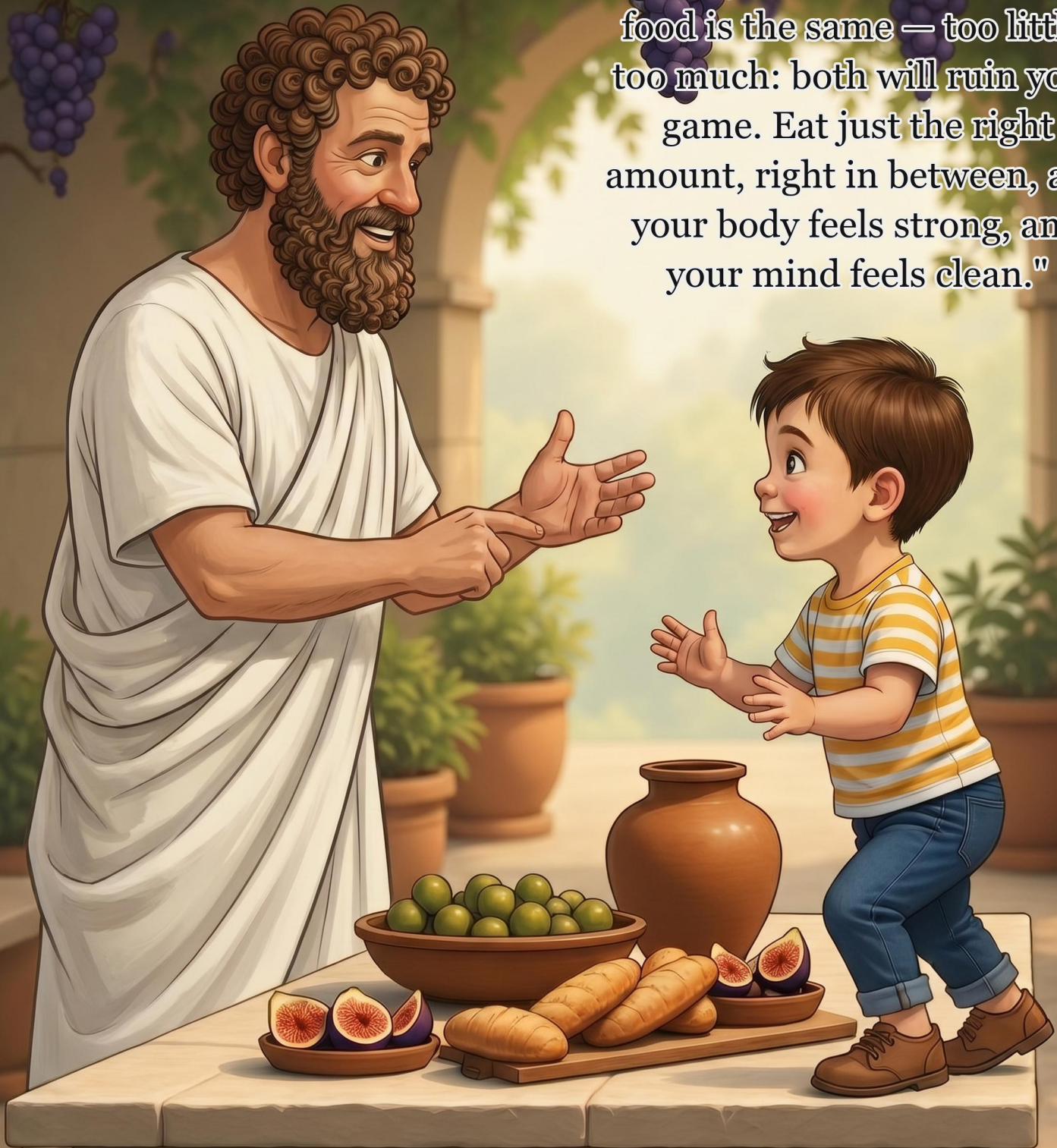
You stumble through mornings with eyes full of lead
when you need a bit more — or a bit less — in bed.

"But just the right sleep — what a difference it makes!
You're sharp and you're ready for all your day takes."



The Kid clapped his hands with a laugh and a shout.
"So the right-in-the-middle is what it's about?"

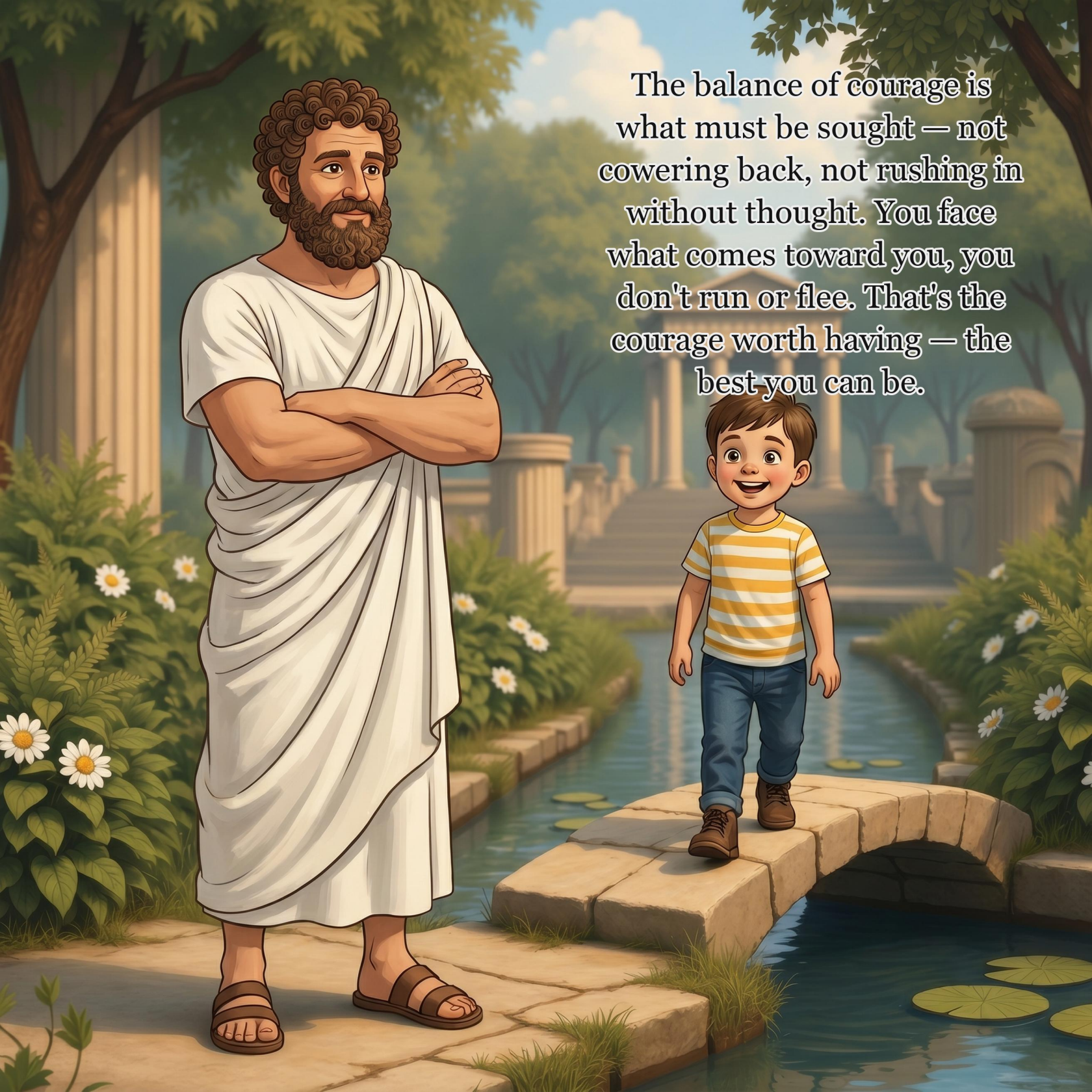
"Exactly!" said Aristotle. "And food is the same — too little, too much: both will ruin your game. Eat just the right amount, right in between, and your body feels strong, and your mind feels clean."



"And courage?" he asked, spreading his arms open wide.
"Too little means hiding — you miss the whole ride.
Too much means you're reckless, you rush in too fast —
the kind of brave moment that never quite lasts."



The balance of courage is what must be sought — not cowering back, not rushing in without thought. You face what comes toward you, you don't run or flee. That's the courage worth having — the best you can be.



They walked to a table where
a bowl sat with care, full of
ripe purple figs in the
afternoon air. The Kid looked
them over — so round and so
bright — each one at its finest,
its perfect just-right.



The Kid stared a moment,
then grinned ear to ear. "Not
too many, not too few — is
that what I hear? It's not just
for figs or for sleeping or food
— it's the rule for all things,
for the bad and the good?"

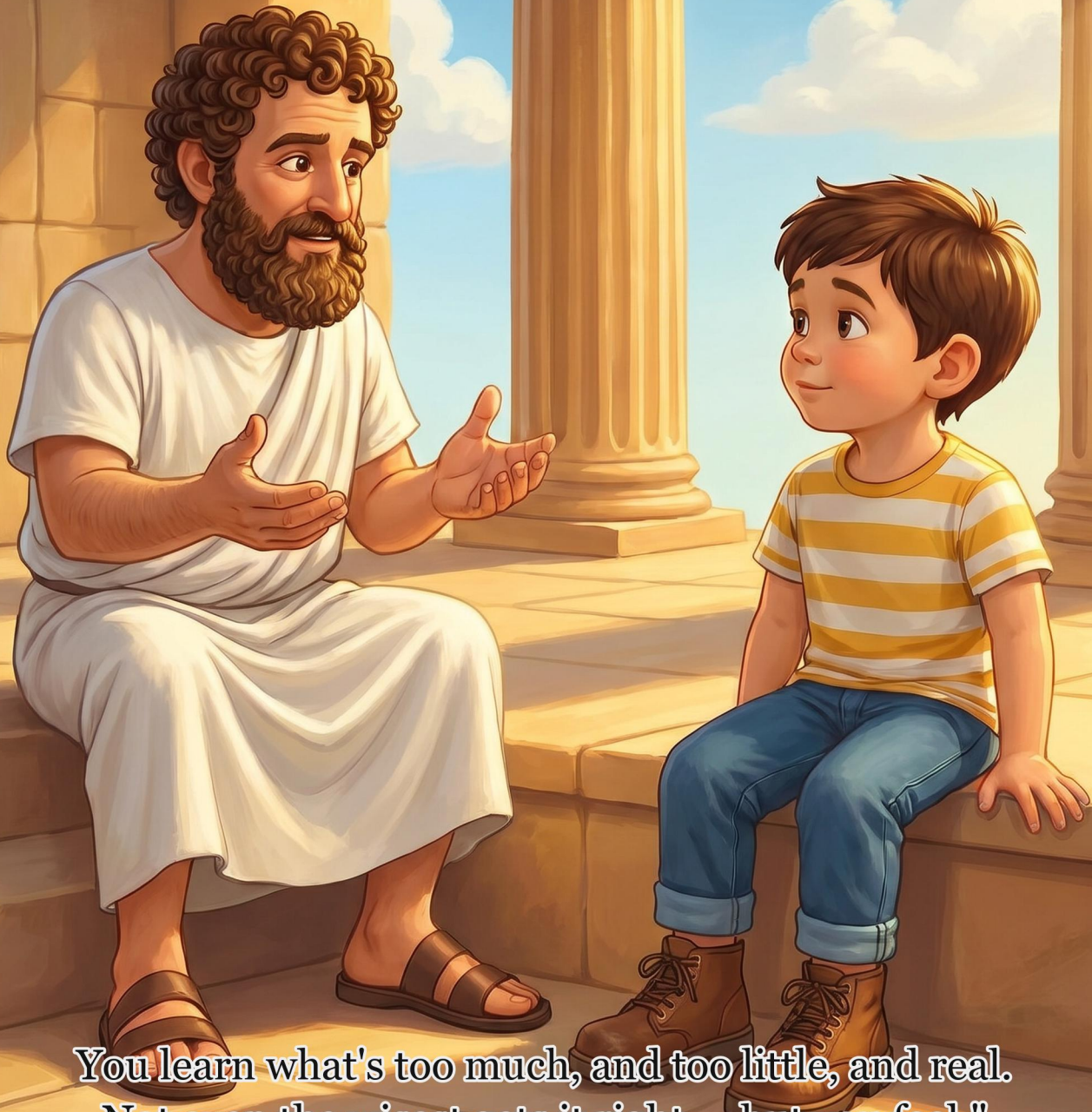


Aristotle laughed with a warm, rolling sound.
"Now you've found it — the wisest thing around!"



In all things," he said, "find the beautiful mean —
the wisest, the strongest, the best in between."

"But how do I find it?" the Kid asked with care.
"You practice," said Aristotle. "You learn to compare."



You learn what's too much, and too little, and real.
Not even the wisest gets it right — but you feel."



"We overshoot, undershoot, lose our own way.
Not even the wisest gets it right every day.
But trying is how all good people grow wise —
you look for the mean, not the lows, not the highs."

The courtyard grew blurry, the columns turned bright.
The Kid felt the world start to spin back to light.
"Wait!" called the Kid. "I don't want to go!"
"You'll carry the lesson," said the teacher. "You know."



He woke up at home, in his warm, quiet bed.
The scroll was still there, by his pillow and head.



He sat for a moment and thought of the day —
the courtyard, the figs, and the teacher's warm way.



He thought of his sleep
and his breakfast that
morn. He thought of his
courage when he felt a
bit worn.

He thought of the fig
bowl, the sunlight, the
stone. "Not too much,
not too few" — now he'd
carry it home.



Not too much and not too few —
the middle way in all you do.



Stay curious.

IRONWOOD BOOKS • ironwoodbooks.com